

Why not just use a CRM?

A CRM is a **system of record** — structured slots you fill in and later struggle to read back. Faragopedia is a **system of understanding**: it reads your material, writes it up as interlinked pages, and keeps the whole thing current on its own. The question was never “which is the better CRM?” It’s that **no CRM does this at all** — and this is the capability the business actually lacked.

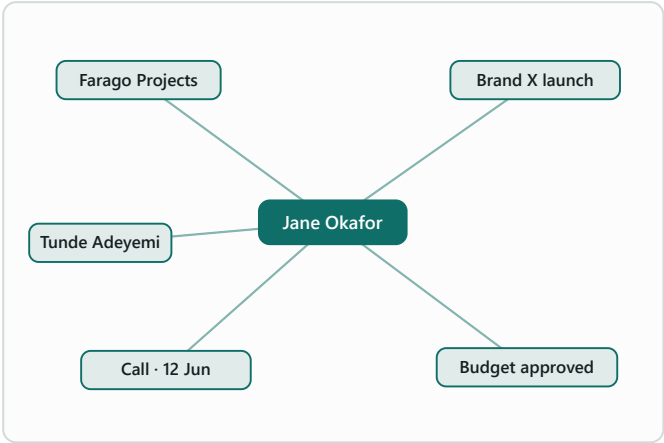
THE CORE DIFFERENCE - TWO WAYS TO HOLD WHAT YOU KNOW

A CRM RECORD

CONTACT · JANE OKAFOR	
NAME	Jane Okafor
COMPANY	— not filled in
EMAIL	— not filled in
STAGE	Lead
NOTES	free text, rarely re-read

Structured slots, siloed from every other record — empty until a human fills them in.

THE SAME PERSON IN FARAGOPEDIA



VS.

One node in a graph you can see — every link written & maintained by the AI, traceable to its source.

THE CRUX The difference isn't cosmetic: a record stores fields; a graph stores meaning. Every advantage below follows from that one distinction.

THREE THINGS A SUBSCRIPTION CRM WON'T DO

- 01 It reads and writes itself**

Drop in a document, email, web article or PDF and the AI pulls out what matters, updates the right pages & wires up cross-references. A CRM's fields stay empty until a human types.

Ingestion: **source in → linked pages out**
- 02 Knowledge is linked, not filed**

Every person, company & project is a node in a graph you can see whole (Link View). A CRM can filter a list; it can't show you the shape of what you know.

View: **the whole network**, not one record
- 03 It keeps itself honest**

A built-in health check finds orphaned pages, broken links, stale claims & contradictions — and proposes fixes. CRM data quietly rots because nobody audits it.

Upkeep: **AI-audited**, not left to rot

SAME PERSON, TWO VERY DIFFERENT OBJECTS

	OFF-THE-SHELF CRM	FARAGOPEDIA
WHAT IT HOLDS	Records in fixed fields	Interlinked pages of synthesised knowledge
GETTING DATA IN	Manual entry into forms	AI reads docs, web & PDFs, writes pages
FREE-TEXT NOTES	Buried, rarely re-read	Synthesised into linked, maintained pages
RELATIONSHIPS	Filtered lists & kanban	A visual knowledge graph (Link View)
STAYING ACCURATE	Degrades; no audit	AI health-check flags stale & conflicting claims
OWNERSHIP	Rented; export is painful	Plain markdown we self-host & own

What a CRM leaves you paying for anyway

+ Per-seat CRM **fees** — **\$12-\$175+**/user/mo — plus onboarding **\$1,500-\$3,500**

+ A separate **wiki / knowledge base** (Notion, Confluence) — a CRM can't hold synthesised knowledge

+ An **AI or search add-on** to make any of it retrievable

+ The **human hours** to keep notes written, linked & current

Typical 2026 market pricing — and it's rented: even fully paid-up, a CRM can't read a document, link it, or keep it current.

Where a CRM genuinely wins

✓ Deal **pipeline**, quotes & forecasting — Faragopedia has no sales funnel

✓ Native **email & calendar** logging

✓ **Multi-user** accounts & permissions — Faragopedia's MVP is single-tenant today (on the roadmap)

✓ Structured **dashboards**, mobile apps, vendor support

Faragopedia isn't a CRM replacement — it's the **institutional-memory layer** a CRM has never provided. Run a CRM for the pipeline if we need one; let Faragopedia hold the understanding.

BOTTOM LINE

A CRM would give us **tidy records we'd still have to read, maintain and connect ourselves**. Faragopedia reads our material, links it, keeps it current, and shows us the whole picture — self-hosted and ours. A CRM remembers what we typed. This **understands what we know**.